

Congratulations! You have started an important stage in your orthodontic treatment. This is the best time to correct the discrepancy with your bite - while you are young and still growing.

What to Expect

The Herbst Appliance stimulates your lower jaw to grow at a more rapid pace, which allows it to “catch up” to your upper jaw. Achieving this growth now prevents future extractions of your permanent teeth and even reduces the possibility of surgery.

- The Herbst Appliance will remain in your mouth for about 12 months (adults: 12-14 months).

When it is first placed:

- Your teeth will not “fit” together.
- Your teeth will be sore for 7-14 days.
- You will need to eat soft foods for 10-14 days.
- The assistant will place small adjusters on your sidebars. These will slide up and down on the sidebars which is normal.

During the 12 months:

- Your Herbst will be checked every 8-12 weeks. Periodic adjustments may be made.
- Your Herbst Appliance will be over-corrected and cause an under-bite (bottom teeth move in front of upper teeth) to allow for some relaxation of muscle structure after it is removed. This may happen as soon as the first Herbst adjustment appointment.
- Braces are required during and after the Herbst to align your teeth and your bite.

Caring for Your Appliance

Avoid the following foods and items:

- Hard and chewy candies
- Ice
- Chewing on pens and pencils
- Sticky foods
- Popcorn kernels (Be careful when eating popped popcorn!)
- Eat smaller bites of hard foods (i.e. slice apples, break up tacos or nachos into bite-sized pieces, etc.)

Remember:

- Good oral hygiene is very important.
- Brush your teeth, gums, and Herbst sidebars after every meal and at bedtime with a soft-bristled toothbrush.
- Make sure you spend enough time in each area to remove all the plaque and to massage your gums. If your gums get red or puffy and bleed, massage them with a toothbrush and rinse with an antiseptic oral cleanser such as Peroxyl (Colgate) and salt water rinses.
- Use sugar-free gum on any areas that are causing irritation to your cheek or lip area. Chew a piece of sugar-free (Xylitol) gum; break off a small piece, depending on the size of the area you will be placing it on, rub it between your fingers, and then place it over the bothersome area.
- If any part of your Herbst Appliance comes loose, call our office. Save the loose pieces and bring them with you to your appointment.

We are thrilled by the dramatic difference the Herbst Appliance will make in the long-term quality of your life and your smile!